

## CURVES

Patchwork patterns based on curves are less common than those with straight seams, which are easy to cut and stitch. But although curves can be fiddly, they give more options and, with careful

preparation at every stage from template making to cutting and pinning, they are straightforward to sew. Many people find curves easier to work by hand, but it is not difficult to machine stitch them.

### SEWING CURVED SEAMS BY HAND



**1** Mark the seamlines and any registration marks, especially the centre point, on the wrong side of each piece. If the centre isn't marked on the pattern, fold each piece in half, fingerpress it at the centre seamline, and use the crease as the centre mark.



**2** Place the smaller convex piece right sides together on the concave one, aligning the centre points. Pin the centre point through both pieces. Pin the end points of the marked seamline. Then pin along the seamline every 1 cm ( $\frac{3}{8}$ in) or so, manipulating the fabric to eliminate creases.

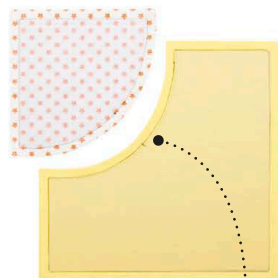


**3** Take out the pin at one end and take the needle through the matching points. You may use a double backstitched loop (see p.40) in the seamline to secure the thread. Do not sew into the seam allowance. Take several short running stitches along the seamline, then pull the needle through. Repeat along the length of the seam, removing pins as you work. Secure the seam further by making a small back stitch each time you bring the needle through.



**4** Check the back to make sure your stitching is on the line on both sides and stop at the matching point at the end. Do not sew into the seam allowance, but use a double backstitched loop to secure the thread. Do not clip the seam allowance. Press the seam towards the convex piece. If your stitching is accurate, the piece will lie flat.

### SEWING CURVED SEAMS BY MACHINE



Mark the centre point of the curve

**1** Make templates and mark the centre of the curve on each one. Cut out the fabric pieces, adding a 6mm ( $\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance. Centre the templates on the wrong side of your fabric pieces, draw around them to mark the seam allowances, then mark the centre point of the curve on the fabric pieces.



**2** Pin the two fabric pieces together at the centre point on the seam allowance, then pin at each end. Pin along the edge to stabilize the curve.



**3** Stitch along the marked curve without stretching or pulling. Remove the pins as you sew. Press the seam towards the convex piece. It should lie flat without being clipped.